



Super Mario Bros. bid hits \$372K
Bidding on a sealed Super Mario Bros. cartridge has reached \$372,000 on Heritage Auctions. <http://digit.in/apr21-29>



Intel "Raptor Lake S"
Intel has officially confirmed the Raptor Lake series on its website, possibly set for a 2022 launch. <http://digit.in/apr21-30>

ZOTAC GeForce RTX 3060 Twin Edge OC Graphics Card

As incremental as it gets

With the RTX 3060, we have the least powerful RTX card in the RTX 30 family with more memory than cards that cost four times as much. It's a weird world and we have AMD to thank for this particular memory arrangement.

The ZOTAC RTX 3060 Twin Edge OC is a slightly pumped up version with a boost overclock of 1807 MHz that puts it 30 MHz over stock. It's a small card with lots of design similarities with the RTX 3060 Ti Twin Edge OC edition. Let's take a closer look at the build.

BUILD

The ZOTAC GeForce RTX 3060 Twin Edge OC has 3584 shader units, 48 ROPs and is clocked at 1320 MHz. The boost clock goes up to 1807 MHz and the memory chips are clocked at 1875 MHz. While it does have a 12 GB video buffer, the memory bus is 192-bits wide so the cumulative bandwidth comes down to 360 GBps. In comparison, the RTX 3060 Ti had a memory bandwidth of 480 GBps. This will matter when you're gaming at higher resolutions.

When we said that the ZOTAC RTX 3060 Twin Edge OC had design similarities, we meant that they're practically the same. If you had the two cards side-by-side, then the only way you could tell the two apart is by looking at the backplate. Everything else is the same. For power, it has a standard 8-PIN PCIe power connector and the cooler is designed for a TDP of 200W. We say that because the cooling assembly is the same as the one on the 3060 Ti Twin Edge OC variant. The cooler uses two fans on top of a large finstack which then has four heat pipes. The PCB also seems very similar. The RTX 3060 uses higher

capacity memory chips so there are two vacant slots whereas the 3060 Ti had all eight slots occupied. Another difference is with the VRM circuitry, we have five power stages for the GPU on the RTX 3060 while the 3060 Ti has six.

PERFORMANCE

Starting off with the synthetic benchmarks, we see that the ZOTAC GeForce RTX 3060 Ti Twin Edge OC scores about 5377 in 3DMark FireStrike Ultra. This puts it in line with the NVIDIA RTX 2060 Super or the RX 5600 XT from AMD. In 3DMark Time Spy, the card gets about 9201 which is a little higher than the RX 5700. So the RTX 3060 is shaping up to be a decent mid-range card as per synthetic benchmarks. In Basemark, the RTX 3060 is 300 points shy of the RTX 2080 in the OpenGL benchmarks and in the DirectX 12 it matches up to the RX 5700 again. There are 10 fewer RT cores in the RTX 3060 compared to the RTX 3060 Ti so we see the score drop down to 24 FPS which is a significant drop. In gaming, this doesn't translate to that big a difference but it makes you wonder what the RTX 3050 Ti might be capable of. You can say that it matches up to the RTX 2070 Super so it's still good for RTX games.



PERFORMANCE.....73
VALUE.....75

Coming to gaming we ended up scoring 126 FPS in Battlefield V, 133 FPS in Death Stranding, 67 FPS in Metro Exodus, 69 FPS in Red Dead Redemption II, 120 FPS in Shadow of the Tomb Raider and 126 FPS in The Witcher III. The RTX 2060 Super had scored 118 FPS in Battlefield V, 133 FPS in Death Stranding, 63 FPS in Metro Exodus, 61 FPS in Red Dead Redemption II, 106 FPS in Shadow of the Tomb Raider and 160 FPS in The Witcher III. The above scores are at 1080p. At 4K, the gap between the two cards comes down to just 1-3 FPS so it's not exactly a great upgrade over the RTX 2060 Super by any means. You'd have to be on an entry-level GPU or perhaps using one of the older gen cards to consider the RTX 3060 for your next upgrade.

VERDICT

The ZOTAC GeForce RTX 3060 Twin Edge OC Graphics Card is a decent mid-range graphics card which brings incremental performance over the older gen RTX 2060 Super graphics card.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

CUDA CORES: 3584 | TENSOR CORES: 112 | RT CORES: 28 | LITHOGRAPHY: 8nm Samsung | TDP: 170W | MEMORY: 12 GB GDDR6 | MEMORY BANDWIDTH: 360 GB/s.

CONTACT

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Price
₹29,500

